

1. Politecnico di Milano

Mercoledì 19/11, 10:30-17:30

Campus Bovisa-Durando

Dipartimento di Design

Room WS3, Building B3

2. Politecnico di Torino

Giovedì 27/11, 10:30-17:30

Castello del Valentino

Room Mollino

RESEARCH SKILLS

About

Research Skills are intensive collaborative seminars where learning experience focuses on the knowledge and practice of designing, planning, developing and communicating a research project. The students will be provided by the necessary knowledge, tools and guidelines to develop **critical thinking about research** and develop **research skills**.

Format

Research Skills adopts an interactive model. It will feature lectures, exercises, presentations and discussions. It is structured around five (5) main topics that students will address each time they work on a research project: the definition of research; the approaches to research; the methodology of research; the research process and the scientific communication of results.

Contents

An Introduction to research

Terminology: ontology, epistemology, methodology and ethics

Paradigms of research: from positivism to participatory

The culture of research in the Sciences and in the Humanities

The practice-based and practice-centered approaches to research

Methodology of research

Strategies of research

Methods of research: collection, analysis and interpretation

The research process

Scientific writing: the abstract, the paper and the thesis

Exercises

Exercise 1

The first exercise focuses on identifying and defining a research topic by articulating the **macro and micro areas of research**: Design a visual representation of the macro and micro areas of your research topic.

Exercise 2

Articulate a possible appropriate **research problem**, question or the main critical issues related to the research topic you identified in exercise 1.

Exercise 3

Select the possible appropriate **research approach** to address your research problem, question or the main critical issues.

Exercise 4 | Group Work

This exercise focuses on describing selected qualitative **strategies of inquiry** and the related methods. It can be developed individually or in groups of 2 to 3 students. Each candidate or group will select one strategy among the following:

- Ethnography;
- Case Studies;
- Performance Ethnography;
- Life History;
- Testimonio;
- Analyzing Interpretive Practice;
- Grounded Theory;
- Participatory Action Research and
- Clinical Research.

Exercise 5

Design a visual representation of your possible **research process**.

Exercise 6

Write an **abstract** to describe your possible research project:

- Topic, interest, etc.;
- Critical issues, problem, gap, etc.;
- Possible methodology: strategie(s) and related methods; and
- Possible final aim(s)

Classroom expectations

As your teacher, I will share with you my knowledge and experience about research skills. You will share your knowledge and interest about a selected research "situation". Through participation and proactive collaboration, we will create a learning environment where all participants listen carefully to each other and feel welcome to contribute to exchanging ideas. We have backgrounds in different areas (Architecture, Design, Engineering and Urban Planning) so I kindly request you to appreciate these differences that will increase the process of learning from each other.

References

DENZIN, K. N., LINCOLN, S. Y., GIARDINA, D. M. & CANNELLA, S. G. (Eds.). (2024). *The Sage Handbook of Qualitative Research* (6th Ed.). Sage.

GASTEL, B., & DAY, A. R. (2024). *How to Write and Publish a Scientific Paper* (9th Ed.). Cambridge University Press.

PHILLIPS, M. E., & JOHNSON, G. C. (2022). *How to Get a PhD: A Handbook for Students and their Supervisors* (7th Ed.). Open University Press.

About your teacher

Fatina Saikaly PhD, BArch.

Fatina studied Architecture in Beirut and did her PhD in Design in Milan. She taught for more than a decade Design Research at the PhD in Design program at the Politecnico di Milano. She is a research, innovation and policy expert in the Creative and Cultural Sectors and Industries (CCSI). She worked at the Accelerator of the European Innovation Council and currently is Vice President of the World Crafts Council Europe. She is co-founder at Co-Creando, a cultural and research association dedicated to crafts and historical cultural manufacturing.

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